

Architect Essentials

Senior M365 expertise -- without the full-time commitment.

Shane McCaw Consulting

Lead Microsoft 365 Architect

shanemccaw.com/retainers/architect-essentials

June 23, 2026



OVERVIEW

A lightweight fractional engagement providing senior Microsoft 365 architectural oversight, governance guidance, and strategic direction for organizations that need expert support without weekly involvement.

WHAT'S INCLUDED

Assessment & Discovery

- Monthly architecture review

Governance & Security

- Governance oversight
- Email/Teams access

Strategy & Roadmap

- Monthly roadmap update
- Architecture guidance
- Governance recommendations

Training & Enablement

- Monthly advisory session

Additional Deliverables

- Escalation support
- Risk identification

ENGAGEMENT PHASES

Monthly Discovery & Prioritization

Establish monthly priorities, review new requests, and align on architectural focus areas

- Conduct monthly alignment call
- Review new business requirements or initiatives
- Identify architectural risks or blockers
- Prioritize tasks for the monthly engagement window
- Monthly priorities summary
- Risk and dependency notes
- Monthly alignment package

Architecture Review & Guidance

Provide architectural oversight, validate designs, and ensure alignment with Microsoft best practices

- Review proposed solutions or configurations
- Validate alignment with M365 architecture standards
- Provide architectural recommendations and alternatives
- Review governance, security, and compliance impacts
- Architecture review notes
- Design validation summary
- Architectural recommendations package

Configuration Oversight & Best Practices

Light configuration review and advisory support within the 10-hour scope

- Review configuration changes made by customer teams
- Identify misconfigurations or risks
- Recommend improvements to Teams, SharePoint, Entra ID, or Exchange
- Validate alignment with governance and lifecycle policies
- Configuration review notes
- Best practice recommendations
- Configuration oversight summary

Security & Compliance Advisory

Lightweight review of security posture and compliance alignment

- Review Conditional Access or identity changes
- Review sensitivity labels, DLP, or retention updates
- Identify emerging risks or gaps
- Provide recommendations for incremental improvements

- Security advisory notes
- Compliance alignment summary
- Security & compliance advisory package

Roadmap & Strategic Guidance

Provide ongoing strategic direction and roadmap refinement

- Review long-term roadmap and upcoming initiatives
- Identify opportunities for automation or modernization
- Recommend sequencing and prioritization
- Align roadmap with licensing, budget, and business goals
- Roadmap update notes
- Strategic recommendations
- Roadmap refinement package

Monthly Summary & Handoff

Summarize completed work, decisions, and next steps

- Compile monthly summary of completed tasks
- Document architectural decisions and rationale
- Provide recommendations for next month's focus
- Close monthly cycle in workflow engine
- Monthly summary report
- Decision log
- Next-month recommendations

KEY FEATURES

- Low-cost entry point
- High-value oversight
- Flexible engagement
- Ideal for early-stage maturity

INVESTMENT

\$2,500 USD

Typical engagement: Ongoing

Price may vary based on complexity, scope, and organizational size.

Expedited delivery available upon request.

WHY THIS SERVICE MATTERS

Mid-market organizations (200-2,000 employees), government contractors, regulated industries (HIPAA, SOC 2, CMMC, ITAR), and startups scaling into compliance -- any organization that needs a senior M365 architect on call without the cost of a full-time hire.

ABOUT THE CONSULTANT

Shane McCaw -- Lead Microsoft 365 Architect with 30 years of experience designing, securing, and governing enterprise Microsoft 365 environments.

CALL TO ACTION

Ready to get started?

Book a free 30-minute discovery call at shanemccaw.com/book

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